Los Angeles Times (1886-Current File); Sep 18, 1966; ProQuest Historical Newspapers Los Angeles Times (1881 - 1986)
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Aerial Tanker Falls in Valley Yard; Pilot Dies

Airman's 'Fantastic' Skill Prevented Loss of Other Lives, Witnesses Say

BY HARRY TRIMBORN
Times Staff Writer

The pilot of a twin-engine aerial tanker was killed Saturday when his disabled plane crashed in a ball of fire in a heavily populated Sun Valley residential area soon after taking off from Lockheed Air Terminal.

Only the skilled airmanship of the pilot, Jack Hennessey, 45, an Air Force combat veteran, prevented the loss of other lives as he sought to jockey his stricken craft onto a vacant lot, witnesses said.

"We owe that pilot our lives," said Mrs. Lydia Wolf, 43, of 7943 Coldwater Canyon Ave.

"He did a fantastic job of flying," said a police officer at the crash scene.

Boy, 5, Injured Slightly

The only injury was to Ronald Metz, 5, of 14219 Califa Way, who was standing about 50 feet from the impact. He was cut slightly on the head by flying debris.

The plane was demolished, but other damage was limited to an abandoned barn, a garage behind Mrs. Wolf's house and two automobiles.

The plane, a converted Navy P-2-V Neptune patrol bomber, slammed into the back yard at 7945 Bellaire Ave. where Mrs. Ulrike Ostermeier, 28, was in a swimming pool.

"I saw the plane coming in real low," said Mrs. Ostermeier. "It wasn't making much noise. I stood up and started running. I just got into my house when it hit."

Slices Through Trees

The plane sliced through several large trees in the backyards at Mrs. Wolf's home and at 7944 Coldwater Canyon Ave. It sideswiped Mrs. Wolf's garage, setting it afire, then slammed into the barn in the vacant lot. Seven County Fire Department units doused the flames.

Mrs. Wolf said her son, Dennis Bonilla, 22, had just entered the house from one of the two cars parked beside the garage.

"I heard the crash," said Mrs. Wolf. "Then all I could see outside the other end of the house was that the sky was red with fire. "I thought Dennis was there, and I screamed for him, but he was all right."

Another witness, Mrs. Sylvia Wachtel, of 7948 Ethel Ave., who was visiting in the area, said she could see the pilot jockeying the plane around houses in an attempt to set it down in the lot. He made his approach along a driveway flanking the Wolf home.

Engine Trouble Reported

Hennessey, of 3033 Chatwin Ave., Long Beach, had taken off shortly before 1 p.m. for Torrance Municipal Airport when he radioed the terminal tower he was having engine trouble and was heading back.

Hennessey was to have participated in a two-day "open house" program at the Torrance field by demonstrating an air drop of fire retardant chemicals.

The pilot was an employee of AJ Air Tankers, Inc., a Lockheed-based firm that supplies aerial fire-fighting equipment to city and county fire departments on a contract basis, fire officials said.

Jack Folz, president of AJ, said Hennessey was an Air Force reserve major who had been a flying and gunnery instructor in World War II. During the Korean conflict he flew combat missions in B-26s. He had been engaged in aerial fire-fighting for the last six years.

Hennessey leaves his wife, Louise, and two sons and two daughters.

CRASH—Firemen wet down the smoking debris of a disabled aerial tanker which missed a home when it crashed but demolished garage at 7943 Coldwater Canyon Ave., killing the pilot, Jack Hennessey, 45.
Times photo

Bias Perils Sacramento Bid for Atom Smasher

Capital's Chances for $375 Million Facility May Hinge on Race Relations Improvement

BY RAY ZEMAN
Times Sacramento Bureau Chief

SACRAMENTO—Racial discrimination charges that threaten Sacramento's chances to win a $375 million atom smasher are being combated in a countywide crusade.

City, county, state and school officials and chamber of commerce and other community leaders are preparing a report for submission late this month to the Atomic Energy Commission.

In a plea for the AEC to construct a 200-billion-electron-volt accelerator 20 miles east of Sacramento, they are outlining Sacramento's political, social, educational, employment and race-relations status.

Simultaneously they are moving to eliminate all discrimination in schools, in sale of new and old homes and in apartment rentals.

The job is enormous. But it may be a vital factor in winning what has been called "the scientific prize of the 20th century"—a gigantic tool more than a mile in diameter.

This will take six or seven years to build, will employ 2,300 scientists and technicians when completed and will cost $60 million a year to operate.

Five other areas rank with Sacramento County as finalists in the competition as a site for the project. They are Ann Arbor, Mich.; Upton, N.Y.; Weston, Ill.; Madison, Wis., and Denver.

Home for Atom Smasher

Last April 9 chairman Glenn Seaborg headed an AEC delegation which inspected the 4,117-acre property in the Sierra foothills proposed as a home for the atom smasher.

Later the Legislature set aside $15 million to purchase this ranch—if California wins the prize.

But three months ago four Sacramento civil rights groups aimed a torpedo at the proposal.

The State Employes for Equality, Sacramento Committee for Fair Housing, Catholic Council on Human Relations and the Congress of Racial Equality expressed concern to Seaborg over "the residential segregation patterns in the Sacramento area."

They wrote the AEC chairman that 86 to 90% discrimination is practiced in rental of apartments.

They feared further aggravation of the problem if the $375 million accelerator was built near Sacramento.

Robert Tyler, Sacramento director of CORE, said: "We need a positive commitment of open rental policies from apartment owners. The burden is on them.

"We'd rather see the atom smasher in Denver than here," he continued, "if the housing situation in Sacramento is going to remain the way it is."

Seaborg wrote to California atomic energy development officials that "this issue is an important one."

Major Problems Being Created

Dr. Edward J. Lofgren, University of California nuclear physicist who is director of designs study for the AEC project, warned that the civil rights groups are creating "major problems" which could lead to rejection of the Sacramento County site.

After the Seaborg-Lofgren warnings, the Sacramento County Board of Supervisors promptly passed a resolution calling upon everyone to end discrimination and maintain an "open" policy. The City Council followed suit a week later.

The Associated Home Builders of Sacramento Valley and the Sacramento Real Estate Board urged further implementation of their code against discrimination.

President Archie Hefner and assistant general manager William F. Hauser of the Chamber of Commerce called a series of meetings of city, county, state, human relations, fair employment, education, real estate, apartment and other officials.

They found plenty of opposition to integration but made progress in discussions.

Main problem was persuading couples who have invested life savings in heavily mortgaged apartments to rent to Negroes.

But Mayor Walter Christensen, chairman Eugene T. Gualco of the Board of Supervisors and Frank Ranells, president of the Sacramento Apartment House and Property

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Reagan Supporter Calls for Repudiation of Birch Society

BY CARL GREENBERG
Times Political Editor

"Complete repudiation" of the John Birch Society by Republican candidates was called for Saturday by one of Ronald Reagan's top supporters, who in turn was urged by a Gov. Brown campaign leader to resign from Reagan's campaign.

Former GOP State Chairman Caspar W. Weinberger, a member of Reagan's steering committee, attacked the Birch Society in a chapter on Republican politics that he wrote for a newly released book, "California Politics and Policies."

Reagan has refused to repudiate the society, saying that he is seeking support from individuals on the basis that they accept his philosophy and that he is not adopting theirs. Reagan did say, though, that he differs with Robert Welch, Birch founder.

Weinberger's assault on the Birch Society led to the resignation suggestion by Bert W. Levit, a Republican and northern chairman of Californians for Brown.

Offering "congratulations," Levit wired Weinberger that his anti-Birch comments are "good advice" but that it is "too bad it is not heeded" by Reagan.

Repudiation 'Essential'

In the book, Weinberger wrote: ". . . It would seem essential, if California's Republican Party is to be given a chance to re-establish principles of individual freedom, that both the ridiculousness and the essential viciousness of the John Birch Society and other groups like it be demonstrated and repudiated by Republicans.

"The society's own idiocies, the official Democratic propaganda line and—most important of all—Republican integrity, compel unequivocal rejection of the Birch Society or its support.

"Republican candidates who equivocate on this issue will be bedeviled by the press and Democrats to such an extent that they will always be on the defensive and always talking about the Birch Society.

"Such evasions as, 'Oh, they would never support me, anyway,' or, 'They aren't a big enough group to be a problem,' or (said with great forthrightness) 'I'll accept the support of any good citizen no matter what group he is in,' or, 'I don't like Robert Welch, but I know some fine people who are members of the Birch Society,' simply won't do.

"The fact is that the Birch Society is an albatross around the neck of the GOP as big as the 'soft-on-communism' label under which the state's Democratic Party has suffered for so many years.

"It is an albatross that should be sloughed off, or whatever it is one does to get rid of an albatross, as soon as possible. The only way to do it is by complete repudiation."

In San Francisco, Weinberger

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Brown Cutting Into Reagan's Early Lead

Continued from First Page

sion to prior voter tendencies. Brown leads Reagan in the North by 6% of the vote.

Reagan has consistently led Brown in the southern portion of the state, which is still the case in the current survey. However, even in the South, Brown has gained 5% of the vote. Reagan's southern total has fallen off 3% from late June.

The current survey was conducted just after the Sept. 9 official kickoff of the Reagan general election campaign. Reagan's television announcement in January that he would seek the Republican nomination significantly affected the results of the State Poll for that month His general election kickoff apparently did little to offset the exposure which Brown received when he began his general election campaign the week before.

The most important questions posed by the present survey are whether the percentages represent a return from the emotion of the immediate post-primary period to somewhat of an equilibrium or whether the percentages are the signposts denoting the beginning of a trend which will ultimately result in Brown overtaking Reagan.

Before the primary, the difference between the two candidates ran between 4% and 5%:

	Sept. %	Late June %	Early June %	May %	March %	Jan. %
Reagan	45	48	43	46	46	47
Brown	41	37	40	43	42	42
Don't know	14	15	17	11	12	11

Because of the preponderance of Democratic registration in California, a Republican candidate must attract about one-fourth of the Democrats in addition to keeping his Republican support largely intact in order to win a statewide election. Reagan's percentage of the Democratic vote in subsequent polls could provide a clue to the way in which the election is going.

Monday: The State Poll will report its findings concerning the contests for lieutenant governor and attorney general. Tuesday's report will include the remaining constitutional offices. This series will conclude with public reaction to recent events in the news.

Breeze Cuts Heat; Cooler Weather Predicted Today

The Southland appeared to be cooling off Saturday with the Weather Bureau predicting a high today of only 87 in downtown Los Angeles after three days of 90-plus temperatures.

Warmth began a rising curve last Monday when the high of 79 degrees was followed by 85 on Tuesday, 88 Wednesday, 91 Thursday, 96 Friday and 92 Saturday.

Increasingly heavy smog and relatively low humidities complicated the condition later in the week, but a break came shortly after noon Saturday when a brisk onshore breeze set in.

The Air Pollution Control District said that the smog reading at the Civic Center reached only .37 parts per million compared with .47 on Friday, .3 below the alert level.

Warm weather on the last weekend before the opening of public schools drew large crowds to Southland beaches. Bathers and baskers enjoyed clear skies, temperatures in the 70s and water temperatures of around 67 degrees.

Clear sunny skies will prevail through Monday except for some early morning fog and low clouds the Weather Bureau said.

L.A. City Schools Will Open Monday for 794,000 Students

BY DICK TURPIN
Times Education Writer

Los Angeles city schools, expecting an enrollment of 794,000, will start the new school year Monday belatedly but with a saving of about $150,000.

Opening of the fall semester was delayed a week by the Board of Education to save money by avoiding conflict with Jewish Holy Days and the subsequent absenteeism among students and teachers.

As many as 100,000 children and 2,000 teachers possibly could be absent if school were in session during Rosh Hashanah, Louis Barak, history teacher at Grant High School and spokesman for Jewish teachers, told the board convincingly last February.

He estimated that $150,000 in state aid, based on average daily attendance, would be lost to the school system as the result of an exodus of students from such high schools as Fairfax, Hamilton, Palisades, University, Taft and Grant.

Rosh Hashanah started Thursday and its observance is based on the lunar calendar. Once every three years the start of the High Holy Days falls within the conventional, early-September school starting date. At the discretion of the board, the opening date can be moved back.

School districts are not reimbursed by the state for pupil absences based on religious observances. Teachers who are absent on Jewish holidays cannot claim excused absences either and must forfeit wages.

The new school year will run for 177 teaching days, ending June 23, a week later than usual to compensate for the delayed opening. The fall semester will end Feb. 3, 1967, and the spring term will begin Feb. 7.

More than 637,000 of those entering school today will be the kindergarten through high school level. Another 157,000 will be enrolled in junior college and adult education classes.

More than 31,000 teachers are assigned to 428 elementary schools, 71 junior high schools, 53 senior high schools, 6 junior colleges, 28 adult education schools and 13 schools for the physically handicapped.

Upwards of 25,000 children will be new to the system and about 2,000 teachers will be new here, too.

LAST WAVE OF SUMMER—The impending end of summer vacation period finds the Southland's beaches and water jammed with people getting away from the heat. Among them, at Santa Monica Beach, is Linda Cowan, 18, who cools off while surfers ride the breakers to shore.
Times photo

Foisie Opens Times' Fourth Asian Bureau in Bangkok

The Los Angeles Times has opened a news bureau in Bangkok, Thailand, with Jack Foisie as bureau chief.

Foisie, 47, has been chief of The Times' Saigon bureau, which he opened in 1964, for the past two years.

Jack Foisie

The Saigon bureau is now headed by William Tuohy, who with correspondent John Randolph continues to provide Vietnamese coverage for Times readers.

Foisie's dispatches from Vietnam this year won the Overseas Press Club prize for Best Interpretation of Foreign Affairs of any daily newspaper or wire service.

The decision to establish a news bureau in Thailand was based on that nation's emergence as a prime target for Communist subversion and as a key base in the air war against Communist aggression in Vietnam.

In addition to covering Thailand, Foisie will report on developments in neighboring nations.

The Bangkok bureau is The Times' fourth in Asia. The others, in addition to Saigon, are in Tokyo and Hong Kong.

BAFFLER JACKPOT REACHES $4,250

The richest Baffler jackpot of the year, $4,250, is being offered for the correct answers in this week's new Baffler puzzle contest. Last week, the crafty Baffler outwitted all readers.

Jackpot details, rules, clues and this week's new puzzle may be found on Page 16 of Section II.

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